

power of their personalities. They would come back to the office and boast about the money they had made that day. Then the orders would be canceled—or it would turn out the salesman had forced a purchase which simply could not be paid for, a fact which would have been apparent if the salesman had taken the trouble to listen and understand.

Enthusiasm needs a focus. The very existence of the focus makes you have something besides enthusiasm to offer.

In honest (and successful) selling of products or services, the focus is *the customer's best interests*. Do you wish the customer to accept, from your mind, the idea that he must own your product or service to make his life a better life? Very well:

Be prepared to answer his questions. Know your product or service inside-out. Know how he can apply the product to his own needs. (You can tell him enthusiastically; but enthusiasm is no substitute for information.)

If you make an appointment, be there on time. Recognize the customer as a man whose time is valuable. (Your enthusiastic story of why you were delayed is not an acceptable substitute.)

If you promise service, make sure the customer gets it. There is no customer like a repeat customer.

But this is not the course on salesmanship, so I forbear to give you a list which could cover a couple of pages. You see the principle: *Enthusiasm needs something solid behind it.*

How to focus your enthusiasm when you apply for a job. Any employer likes to talk to a man who applies enthusiastically for a position with his company. The employer knows that such enthusiasm can be carried over into the man's work, and this is a priceless ingredient.

But remember the law of negatives. By the time a man has given out a few dozen jobs, he has learned the inadvisability of letting anyone talk himself into a job when he has nothing to show but enthusiasm.

A large publishing company has found it advisable to test applicants' real willingness to work by showing them a time clock. It is explained that nothing is accepted as a substitute for starting work on time. This has a remarkable cooling-off effect on certain fast-talking applicants.

Enthusiasm does often put a man into a job, or get him bank credit, or make a sale when the person petitioned feels